

"When I was 5 years old, my mother always told me that happiness was the key to life. When I went to school, they asked what I wanted to be when I grew up. I wrote down "Happy". They told me that I didn't understand the assignment. I told them that they didn't understand life."

Find a strong reason for financial freedom and life will be a lot happier and worthwhile. It is only your reason that will push you to finish this journey much faster and thus enable you to start "living" your life.

Decide to become wealthy

Money is power. And power in good hands is a very good thing. Each person's definition of wealth is personal. To me, you become truly wealthy and financially independent once you no longer have to think of money, and you can focus on the 'real' goals of life.

The decision to be financially independent is ultimately yours. Most people never become wealthy and financially independent because they never decide to do so. They may hope or wish for wealth and financial freedom, but never really choose. Choice is the beginning of all journeys. As Napoleon Hill wrote in his classic book: *Think and Grow Rich*: Riches begin with a state of mind and with definiteness of purpose.

Once we decide to obtain something, the mind unconsciously begins to create the reality necessary to make the desire real. This has also been amply justified in the famous book, *The Alchemist*, which says: *"And, when you want something, all the universe conspires in helping you to achieve it."*

The journey of a thousand miles begins with a single step. Take your first step. Decide to be wealthy. Declare your intention to yourself and your family. Write it on a piece of card and keep it with you. Make a commitment. Love it. Even if it feels a little awkward, go ahead and write it down. This is the first step in your remarkable journey towards financial freedom.

Start early